

PREMIUM

Pre-Departure Checklist

From visa confirmed to entering Germany/the Schengen area

2-4 weeks before departure

- Check your visa sticker: validity dates, entries permitted, and that your passport details match
- Check your passport's remaining validity - at least 3 months beyond your planned departure from the Schengen area
- Confirm flights and accommodation for every night of your trip
- Keep your travel medical insurance certificate accessible

The week before

- Save or print: passport photo page, visa page, flight itinerary, accommodation confirmation, insurance certificate, and your host's Verpflichtungserklärung if applicable
- Reconfirm your day-by-day itinerary if visiting multiple Schengen countries
- Share your itinerary and emergency contacts with someone at home

Day of travel

- Arrive at the airport with sufficient buffer time
- Keep your passport and printed documents in your hand luggage

At the German/Schengen border

A border guard makes the final entry decision at your first point of entry into the Schengen area, and can ask questions consistent with your application.

- Be ready to show your return ticket, accommodation proof, insurance certificate, and your host's Verpflichtungserklärung if relevant
- Track your 90/180-day allowance across the whole Schengen area, not per country